

1. Repartition vs Coalesce

- What is partition?

A partition is a unit of parallel data processing.
More partitions $\rightarrow$ More parallelism.

- Why Partition :- For performance, for parallel processing
~~for~~ for distributed computing

There are two important concepts

1. Choosing right number of partitions
2. Choosing the right size of the partition

Numbers

Suppose there are 16 cores (Executors) then number of partition should be 16 or multiple of 16 for better utilization of all executors or

Size

Evenly distributed partition improves the performance. If we have one partition of 10 MB and other one of 1 GB then first one will finish its task quickly at ~~each~~ site ideally. So overall application will take time while processing 1 GB file.

Default partitions of RDD/DF

- The parameter **sc.defaultParallelism** determines the number of partitions when creating data within Spark. Default value is 8
- When reading data from external systems partitions are created by on parameters **Spark.sql.files.maxPartitionBytes**. (Default 128 MB)

- To read a file and to create partition while reading it, the file must be in splittable format.

CSV + Gzip compression is not splittable but Parquet + Snappy is ~~com~~ splittable

• Repartition

What it is?

Repartition is a spark function used to increase or decrease number of partitions

Repartition always shuffle the data and build new partitions from scratch

- Shuffle is one of the costliest operation in spark

Good part about repartition is that it creates partitions in almost equal sizes.

• Coalesce

- Coalesce is only used for decreasing the number of partitions.

- Coalesce doesn't require a full shuffle.
- So Coalesce combines few partitions, or we can say ~~partitions~~ it shuffles data only from few partitions.

- Due to partition merge, it produces uneven size of partitions.

2. Cache vs Persist

- Cache is programming mechanism which gives an option to store the data in memory ~~across~~ across nodes.
- Persist is programming mechanism which gives an option to store the data either in memory or in disk across nodes.

Why Cache/Persist :-

- If we are using a dataframe multiple time, Spark will calculate that dataframe everytime.
- If we can store the df then Spark will use it and there will be increase in performance.

Example

```
df1 = Spark.read.csv("path")
df2 = df1.filter(...)
df3 = df2.withColumn(...)
df4 = df2.withColumn(...)
df5 = df2.withColumn(...)
```

Here we are using df2 again and again and suppose that these operation has some action in middle also, so it better to store df2 dataframe so that we don't need to calculate it again again.

- So if we can improve the performance by caching the df2 dataframe why don't we store all the dataframe then.

1. If it is used only one time then there is no use of storing it.

2. Storing all the df's will take lots of memory from the executors, which will later raise the

- Cache always store data in memory and never in disk.
- ~~Cache~~ Persist can store data either in memory or in disk or in both memory and disk.

Syntax of Persist()
`df.persist()`

With persist we can choose

- Memory or disk (Where to store)
- Serialized vs Deserialized (How data is stored)
- Replication

`df.persist(StorageLevel.MEMORY_ONLY)`

What is
only memory

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more

data in

memory size.

• Different Storage Levels.

1. MEMORY_ONLY :- Same as Coherence today
2. MEMORY_ONLY_SER :- Persisting the RDD in a Serialized (binary) form helps to reduce the size of the RDD, thus making space for more RDD to be persisted in cache memory. Space efficient but not time-efficient
3. MEMORY_AND_DISK :- Store partitions in Disk which not fit in memory.
4. Memory and Disk - SER :- Both in memory in disk but with Serialized.
5. DISK_ONLY :- Persist data in disk only, which would require network input and output operation thus time consuming. But still better than re-computation each time through DAG.

DISK_ONLY_2

MEMORY_AND_DISK_2

MEMORY_ONLY_2

MEMORY AND DISK ONLY - SER 2.

Same as above but it create replication in another node so. if any failure of node, still data is accessible through it

- What happens If Data > Memory While persist or Cache?

When data doesn't fit, Spark does not spill to disk,

Some partitions are cached in memory and others are not cached.

When we reuse the dataframe, Cached partition operations are fast, Uncached recomputed from lineage.

3. Broadcast Variable

It is programming mechanism in Spark, through which we can keep read-only copy of data into each node of the cluster instead of sending it to every time a task needs it.

- A read-only copy of data sent to every executor, stored locally on each node.

`broadcast_val = Spark.SparkContext.broadcast(my_dict)`

What happens.

1. Driver has my_dict
2. Spark serializes it
3. Sends it to executors using TorrentBroadcast
4. Each executor store a local copy in memory

- It avoids data shuffle thus improve performance
- It is ideal for joining situation where one side of join is tiny table.
- Only suitable for smaller tables as it gets cached in each node. If created for larger tables, it would consume memory of each of worker node thus hitting the performance.
- The size of the broadcast variable should fit into driver memory otherwise leading to OOM issues.

from pyspark.sql.functions import broadcast

joindf = df.join(broadcast(df2), "store_id", "inner")

joindf.explain()

